Terrorist Front is parading around the families of some of the security personnel who were killed during the Attack. They have threatened to return the government's posthumous bravery medals if Afzal is not hanged by 12 December. (On balance, it might not be a bad idea for them to turn in those medals until they really know *who* the attackers were working for.)*

The main strategy seems to be to create confusion and polarize the debate on communal lines. The Editor of *The Pioneer*[9] wrote that Mohammad Afzal was actually one of the men who attacked Parliament, that he was the first to open fire and kill at least three security guards. The columnist Swapan Dasgupta,[10] in an article called 'You can't be Good to Evil', suggests that if Afzal is not hanged there would be no point in celebrating Dussehra or Durga Puja. It's hard to believe that falsehoods like this stem only from a poor grasp of facts.

In the business of spreading confusion, the mass media, particularly television journalists, can be counted on to be perfect collaborators. On discussions, chat shows and 'special reports', we have television anchors playing around with crucial facts, like young children in a sandpit. Torturers, estranged brothers, senior police officers and politicians are emerging from the woodwork and talking. The more they talk, the more interesting it all becomes.

At the end of November 2006, Afzal's older brother Aijaz made it onto a national news channel (CNN- IBN).[11] He was featured on hidden camera, on what was meant to be a 'sting' operation, making—we were asked to believe—stunning revelations. Aijaz's story had already been on offer to various journalists on the streets of Delhi for weeks. People were wary of him because his rift with his brother's wife and family is well known. More significantly, in Kashmir he is known to have a relationship with the STF. More than one person has suggested an audit of his newfound assets.

But here he was now, on the national news, first endorsing the Supreme Court decision to hang his brother. Then saying Afzal had never surrendered, and that it was *he* (Aijaz), who surrendered his brother's weapon to the BSF! And since he had never surrendered, Aijaz was able to 'confirm' that Afzal was an active militant with the Jaish-e-Mohammad, and that Ghazi Baba, Chief of Operations of the Jaish, used to regularly hold meetings in their home. (Aijaz claims that when Ghazi Baba was killed, it was he—*Aijaz*—that the police called in to identify the body). On the whole, it sounded as though there had been a case of mistaken identity—and that given how much he